



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*naiṣkarmyam apy acyuta-bhāva-varjitam
na śobhate jñānam alaṁ nirañjanam |
kutaḥ punaḥ śaśvad abhadram īśvare
na cārpiṭam karma yad apy akāraṇam || [BhP 1.5.12]
na hy aṅgopakrame dhvaṁso
mad-dharmasyoddhavāṇv api |
mayā vyavasitaḥ samyañ
nirguṇatvād anāśiṣaḥ || [BhP 11.29.20]*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

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GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It suggests that knowledge itself, though pure and untainted (nirañjanam), doesn't shine its brightest without the illumination of divine love. How much more, then, do actions performed without offering to the Supreme, especially those driven by selfish motives, become sources of suffering?

The second verse assures us of the indestructible nature of the path of devotion. Even a small step (aṅv api) taken towards embracing one's dharma, guided by the Divine, is never lost. It highlights that the path laid out by the Supreme is complete and unwavering because it transcends the limitations of material qualities (nirguṇatvād) and selfish desires (anāśiṣaḥ).

In modern life, these verses offer a powerful antidote to the pervasive sense of meaninglessness that can arise from a focus solely on achievement and material success. You might dedicate yourself to mastering a skill, building a career, or accumulating wealth, but if your actions are not infused with a sense of purpose beyond yourself, a connection to something greater, you may still find yourself feeling empty. The verses invite you to examine your motivations, to consider whether your actions are aligned with your deepest values and whether they contribute to the well-being of others. By offering your efforts, your talents, your very life to a higher purpose, you transform ordinary actions into acts of devotion, infusing them with meaning and enduring value. Even small acts of kindness, performed with love and offered to the Divine, can have a profound and lasting impact. Remember that your sincere efforts, however imperfect, are never in vain on the path of devotion.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you offering your daily actions as a devotional act to something greater than yourself, and how might this shift your perspective on your purpose?